

Private Worship Vol IV - 9

Power Without Love Explains Why Great Ministries Can Drift

I tried to get away from what He wanted me to tell you. When I had this last service, I knew I could not get away from it. I would be under obligation to tell you whether I wanted to or not, which basically I wanted to more than not.

Some of you may have noticed that there has been a lot of teaching on the love of God lately. From Allen to Gary to any of us getting up here, we would say something about it. Gary carried it to a place some time ago, and that is what turned me and changed me.

It is that thirteenth chapter, where Paul says:

Covet earnestly the best gifts: and yet shew I unto you a more excellent way. Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, and have not charity, I am become as sounding brass, or a tinkling cymbal.

He goes on to list power ministries and everything, and at the end he says it profits me nothing.

I used to think that if a person could really operate in a lot of power, his life had to be beyond reproach. That turned out not to be so. One of the times that everything went through me about fifty times, and I was looking at circumstances, God, and everything, was when I started going back and studying the lives of men who shook everything.

I thank God for the ones bold enough to write it all in there, the bad and the good. You cannot say Branham's name without people knowing about him. William Branham was a world shaker. Every ministry has heard of him, the word of knowledge he operated in, and the power he operated in.

Alexander Dowie brought Chicago to its knees. People poured into Chicago to hear him preach. These men were walking power plants. But if you do not think the devil is a good imitator, and if you do not think deception is powerful, think again.

Somewhere in there, he can slip in and replace the voice of God with his voice, and a person can end up thinking it is really God. It has happened more than once.

Sensationalism and Deception Can Replace the Voice of God

With Alexander Dowie, after shaking Chicago, one day he got himself a long robe, a tall hat, a flowing gown, and looked like a priest. He ascended up to his little throne, a kind of king's chair exalted above others, and announced he was Elijah to come. He was buying land around Israel because he and Jesus were going to reign through the millennium around 1977.

Branham was even photographed with a halo, and it was not phony. It was an old black-and-white photograph, but there it was. If somebody wearing a halo came up and said, "I would like to talk to you," I would say, "I will listen."

But remember, we weathered a revival of sensationalism when gold dust and pearls fell. Who do you think made snakes out of the sticks that Pharaoh's sorcerers threw down? God did not do that. The devil can manipulate molecules, but he is created. He cannot create something out of nothing. He has to have something to make something.

Branham eventually said women were born without a spirit. At one time he even said they were born lower than the animal kingdom. How could he go from power to that?

Paul did not say, "Though I pray with tongues." He said, "Though I speak with tongues of men and angels." A man can have the gift of faith to move mountains and still not have love. Somehow, in the end, without love, he comes out not profiting much.

I did not launch myself into the study of the love of God. It seemed to come to me somewhere along the way in the edification process from praying in tongues. He taught me about this, this, and this. For a while I operated in more love than I ever had in my life. People would cry and get healed. It was not long before I got to thinking I was somebody.

He could not give me any more, but I did not stop praying in tongues. I did have a break there, but I always go back.

The Final Door Opened in Brazil After Years of Preparation

When I got myself straightened back around and prayed, Brazil was breaking wide open, and now Japan is breaking open. I got to the last door. I noticed there were no more doors like the ones He had given me before, but there was a door here. I was pushing on the door and trying keys, but I could not get it to open like the others.

I was near Sao Paulo, Brazil, ten stories up in a hotel room. I had been preaching in Brazil for almost twenty years, and it was just like any other meeting. The room had two areas: the bedroom with two small twin beds, and a little kitchen area. I slept in the bed by the wall.

I do not usually see things. One time I had a vision of an angel standing there. I saw him for a minute in a vision. I do not think he saw me. Another time devils swept out over a room and started chanting, "Something is wrong here." That was all gone in a second.

In the days of the gold dust, I had an encounter where I heard voices chanting and singing over and over. I never saw anything, but I heard them. They sang a song so long I could hardly take it. I thought, "Will they take requests?" I asked them to sing "Shall We Gather at the River," and they came right in on it. Then I asked them to sing Johnny Cash's "Ring of Fire." It got quiet. When they started that, I knew it was the devil. I wanted to hear the end of the song, but I fought that temptation and said, "Okay, it is over. Get out in Jesus' name."

That was the only supernatural encounter I had like that where I heard them but did not see them. Angels can really sing, even bad ones.

The Hotel Room Attack Tried to Stop the Love Door

Now I am ten stories high in Alphaville, a suburb of Sao Paulo. I am at this door. I have been through a lot. I go to bed, with my shoulders partly on the pillow and my hands over my heart. I had put my clothes on the chair at the end of the bed.

I do not know what woke me up, but when I opened my eyes, there was a man sitting in my chair. He was big, tall, wearing very dark clothing. When I moved a little, I put my hand over my heart out of habit. He said to somebody else in the room, "Look, do you think he knows that you are going to kill him with a poisoned dart?"

I had never seen this before. I had seen visions, but you cannot interact with a vision. They do not talk back. He was there.

When he said that, he turned toward the door into the second part of the room, and dark angelic figures began flooding out. Then a woman came out in the middle of them, and they surrounded her like they were protecting her. She had hair cut short and black-gray eyes that could stare a hole through you. She had a smoking flax, lit it, and went down the wall, fanning the smoke up and toward me.

I later found out that in Brazil, especially around the Amazon region, witchcraft like that is used to put a death curse on people.

When she leaned over the bed coming toward me, I shot up out of bed and went after them in the name of Jesus. I said, "In the name of Jesus, you get out of here. You get out of here and do it now."

If they were farther from the wall, they disappeared before reaching it. If they were by the wall, they went through it. By the time I looked over, she was gone. Then they kept chanting, "I am going to kill you."

I was not afraid. So I said, "In the realm I live in, we love our enemies and forgive them. But you are a bunch of dumb devils. You are so stupid, you followed Satan into an eternal hell. How stupid could you be?"

That bought about five minutes of silence.

I lay back down, and after I got to sleep again, a woman came running into the room yelling, "Fire, fire!" She ran back out. I checked the door; it was still locked. I went downstairs and asked the desk if there were any reports of fire. They said no.

Then later I heard people ten stories down in the alley calling, "Pastor Dave Roberson, can you help us?" It was four or five in the morning, in Brazil. I found out he was trying to bait me outside. They wanted to get me outside for some reason.

The Enemy Feared the Love That Would Heal Them All

I wanted to know why I warranted an attack so severe. I had come from meetings of hundreds of thousands of people and watched hundreds of thousands get saved, and I did not get attacked like that. Why now?

God finally showed me. The Word of God is full about love. We discovered that in the new nature there is something like a chromosome, that God's love is part of our new nature. It casts out all fear and never fails. It is so pertinent to answered prayer. If you speak to the mountain and have ought against someone, stop the prayer and fix the ought. Love has so much to do with faith and everything else.

The door I was brought to, with the foundation I have now, was the door where love was. The Lord finally told me those devils were assigned to stop me, kill me, or do anything necessary to keep me from going through that door where that level of the love of God was leaking out of a safe so large you could walk into it.

I had never met devils that afraid of something, but they were afraid of this. They were under assignment to stop me from getting past that door and walking in that kind of love.

Why? Because the fullness of God is operating in the nature He gave you. When Jesus was moved by that kind of compassion, He did not walk away from the sick. He healed them all.

What is the church doing now? What about much of it resembles the Word?

If you have a child who is blind but can hear, or cannot walk but can hear, how do you explain, "I am okay and you are not"? Do you know a church in Tulsa where you could bring a couple of blind children who cannot walk and bring them home whole? They are promising all these great things over money, but cannot get a blind child healed.

Did I get through the door? I got my foot through. I got through enough. I have no fear right now, including fear of failure.

As far as failure goes, I consider not being able to affect a children's hospital very much to be failure.

The Fullness of Love Gives Certainty Before Hospitals

For one minute, the children's hospitals around here, maybe covering three cities, were in front of me. I was not going to go pray for them. I was going to go empty them out.

How do I know? The love of God. We are on the path now. When does love fail?

Can you imagine walking into an event like that with no fear? Jesus was moved by compassion, which is the tangible substance of love, and healed them all.

God is not dependent on air. When He breathed into Adam, He was not dependent on anything He created. He gave him His life, the life that was from Him. Then when Jesus rose, born again, and we rose with Him, born again, there was something in the new nature like a chromosome that made the love of God in me.

It is still me, but it is His love in me. I can take this love and give it to Him, and that is me loving Him. When He gives me His love, that is Him loving me.

What happens if that love fills up? Some of you have some measure of it. What would happen if it kept growing?

Jesus said:

Ye have heard that it hath been said, An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth: But I say unto you, Love your enemies...

Love your enemies, do good to those who hate you, pray for those who spitefully use you. When they take away your goods and steal your money, do not ask for it again. Judge not. Condemn not. Forgive. Give. What is the giving? Whatever that sinner took from you, you do not go after him to get it back.

That is Luke 6:38. God will take whatever it cost you to hold His blood up to that sinner, shake it down, run it together, and cause men to give into your bosom. That verse is not just about another offering.

Death Threats Failed Because the Door Still Opened

I got to touch it. It did not stay, but it shook hell so much that a group of devils got an assignment to come in and do whatever it took to stop me from going through the door.

In the gold dust days, when I had the singing devils, I was back at my house putting something in the back of my truck. A voice came up behind me out loud and said, "I am going to kill you."

I turned around because the voice was there and said, "If you could do that, you would have already done it."

He said, "Then I am going to kill your family."

I said, "No, you are not."

Bill went home, but he was on his way to preach a meeting. My son Steve had gotten saved about a year before. It took the supernatural. I saw where he was, and he got saved.

Steve and his friend overdosed on morphine. Steve got up out of bed, turned around, and saw himself lying there. Then he looked up and saw the outline of an angel through the wall. The angel turned toward him and said, "Get back in." He got back in his body. He sounded like a scared rabbit when he called me. I told him what happened, and he got born again and came home.

Later he was down quite a bit. He had lost his family. She left him and remarried. He had to take something to sleep, but it was the kind of medication where you can wake up and forget you took it.

They rushed him to emergency, and I rode in the ambulance. I asked them to leave me alone with him for a bit. I saw Steve walking away from this, and a bright person was in front of him. I do not know if it was Jesus, an angel, or God. I just knew they were from heaven. He said, "I cannot send you back this time. You have to come with Me." So he did.

The devil threatened me, and I did not know how to handle him then as well as I do now. They are both in heaven, and I am getting my revenge. I was not going to lie down and quit. I made it to the door.

He tried to kill me. They tried. They came so close that my wife and Rosalie were slapping me in the face and doing everything they could to keep me breathing. I passed out from pain. I came that close to death, but he failed. I am here. One more hour and it might have gone into gangrene.

They could not stop me by doing that. They could not kill me. They could not stop me from going through the door. They cannot stop the revival either.

The Final Service Ends With Prayer and the Certainty That He Cannot Stop You

If you desire prayer, and He says anything to me, I will tell you. If you do desire prayer, get your toes on the line.

This is our last service, so we want to tell you that it has been absolutely our privilege to serve you from His table. I am glad I am free to share these things because they are true.

He cannot stop you.